

Multiple sign-in for Gmail

Google officially announced multiple sign-in feature for Gmail. You can now sign-in with up to three accounts simultaneously

Filter spam

Blogger gets a brand new comment system that lets you filter spam with ease

Gmail's VoIP and Priority Inbox

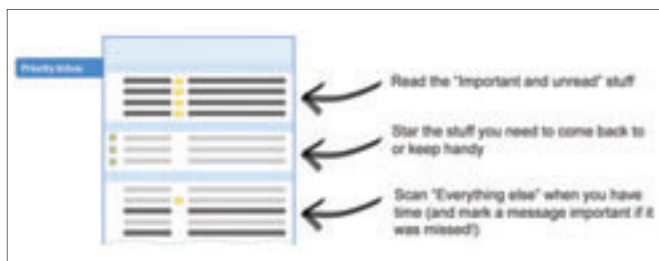
Priority Inbox

Ever faced this scenario? You check your inbox, only to find dozens of unread emails. You scan through them and decide to archive them all rather than read them. Unfortunately, in the process you archive a rather important email.

Gmail's new "Priority Inbox" aims to tackle that

problem. Gmail will learn over time which emails you open, read and reply to and accordingly automatically sort your email to display relevant, important emails first. Email is then put into different sections, important unread email, starred email and everything else after that — these sections can be customized. Just like Gmail's spam system, this too can be trained over time, by marking an email as less or more important.

This reminds us of Mozilla Messaging's Raindrop project which had a similar noble



problem. Gmail will learn over time which emails you open, read and reply to and accordingly automatically sort your email to display relevant, important emails first. Email is then put into different sections, important unread email, starred email and everything else after that — these sections can be customized. Just like Gmail's spam system, this too can be trained over time, by marking an email as less or more important.

goal. While Gmail will obviously provide these features in their web interface, Mozilla Messaging's Raindrop is a mail client application — although it runs its own server and has to be accessed via a browser



— which can aggregate details from multiple social networks to figure out which email is more important to you.

This feature will be rolled out over a week for both Gmail and Google Apps mail users, so keep an eye out. You can try "Priority Inbox" by visiting its new home at Google.

Gmail VoIP

Finally some good is coming of Google's acquisition of Gizmo5. Though Gmail's chat application already supports voice and

video chatting and was recently released for Linux too, Google now also offers the ability to make calls to phone numbers from the Gmail interface. Available only in the US for now, it will work with your Google Voice number and you will be able to not only make calls but also receive any calls made to this number.

Google's been testing the Google Voice service for a while now, which is a very handy feature and we can't wait for it to roll out here in India.

Geolocation comes to Facebook, finally

The web, especially the social web, is getting increasingly interested in your whereabouts. After "What are you doing?" it has now come to "What are you doing, and where are you doing it?"

Twitter added support for geolocation metadata in its tweets quite a while back, which would allow people to see tweets from people in areas around them. Google's Buzz also supports metadata information in its messages, and can show Buzz

posts from users around you as a layer in its Google Maps.

Facebook's take on geolocation is called "Places". You can use the feature with the iPhone via the Facebook iPhone app, or the <http://touch.facebook.com> website if you have an HTML5 and geolocation capable phone and as we've come to expect, you need to be in the USA.

Essentially, the feature allows you to make a Facebook post which can include your geolocation data and also allows tagging of friends who are with you.



Cisco's "Skype" call for VoIP

Less than a week after Google announced their new voice calling feature from Gmail, Skype, a company providing similar VoIP services for years now, is in the headlines. Apparently Cisco Systems is showing an interest in buying Skype.

According to a popular weblog, Skype is hoping for a valuation of about \$5 billion with its IPO. It means this is the minimum price that Cisco needs to offer to make the offer even seem attractive. Cisco is already a big player in

the VoIP services market and an investment as large as \$5 billion is not out of reach for them by any means. In 2005, Cisco had spent \$6.5 billion on cable set-top box

maker Scientific Atlanta.

Whether this rumoured Skype purchase

is intended to expand Cisco's products and services to set it apart from other VoIP competitors, or to become a venture that will strengthen Cisco's strategic value as an acquisition target itself, remains to be seen.

